

[D] shortcut used to hide the desktop momentarily, there has been a Show desktop icon on the Quicklaunch bar. With Windows 7 and the Quick launch not visible anymore, the show desktop function is available as a small bar on the extreme bottom right corner of the screen.

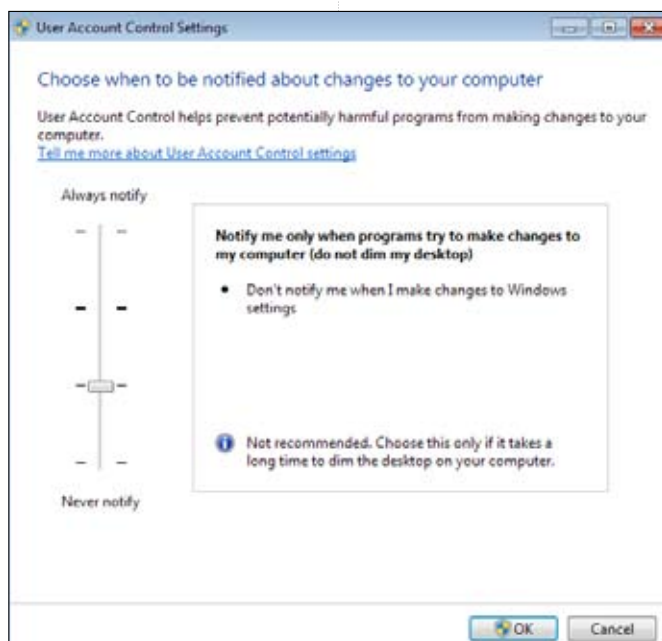
✎ Toning down the UAC

The UAC on Vista was one of the most annoying features that would popup every now and then while certain

moving it around quickly. All the other windows immediately minimise.

✎ Checking for memory problems

No longer do you have to download a third-party application and create a bootable disk to check for memory problems. Windows 7 comes with an inbuilt tool that just needs a reboot to work. It's called Windows Memory Diagnostic and can be found under the Administrative tools



User Account Control Settings now has a slider to change level of strictness

operations were being executed. Users fed up with it turned it off. Windows 7 still has a UAC for security reasons, but it can be reduced to only warn you of absolutely vital operations and for every silly action. The UAC level can be changed by going to going to System and Security under the Control Panel. Look for the Change User Accounts Controls settings link and make the change by moving the sliding down.

✎ Shake the rest away!

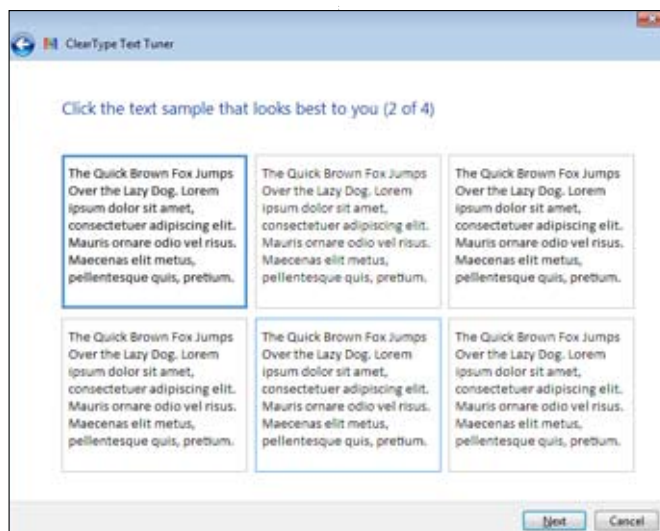
If you have many windows open and for some reason, you want them all minimised except for the one you are currently using, you can do this by clicking on the title bar of the application and

section in the Control Panel.

Run it and it will prompt you. You can reboot immediately or the scan can be set run on the next reboot. The scan takes a while. Press [Esc] at any moment to stop the scan and continue booting into Windows. If there are any errors, you know there are issues with your memory. This is a great tool run if your Windows has been facing random crashes and blue screens.

✎ Built-in cleartype tuner

Windows has built-in cleartype fonts which make text look more rounded. It's visually more appealing than



The built-in ClearType tuning application

standard fonts and is highly recommended for LCD users. Not everyone likes the default look of cleartype fonts and some amount of tweaking is required. The cleartype tuner was available only through Microsoft's site on a web browser. Windows 7 has this utility built into the OS. You can find it under Control Panel > Appearance and Personalization. Click on checkbox to turn on ClearType and follow the steps to complete the tuning.

✎ Including new folder into libraries

Windows 7's set of pre-defined folders for Documents, Pictures,

Music are called libraries. These folders automatically show up in every dialog box when you try to open or save a file. We talked about adding new folders to each of these separate library folders. It's also possible to add new sections into these libraries. This is a particularly useful feature as it reduces the time and steps it would normally take to access a particular folder.

To include a new folder in the library, right-click on the folder in Windows Explorer. Next, click on Include in library > Create new library.



Adding multiple folders to a library folder

✎ Gadget placement in Windows 7

One of the new features that Vista brought was the sidebar which was used to house gadgets. There is a huge gallery of such gadgets on Microsoft's web site. The sidebar application by itself consumed resources as well as desktop space. Windows 7 now lets you place gadgets anywhere on the desktop. Right-click on the desktop and click on Gadgets. Drag and drop the gadget you want to anywhere on the desktop.

✎ Enabling Windows XP virtualisation mode

Windows 7 has support for a Windows XP virtual machine which basically